Tunable Inter-Body Hole Coupling in a Divided-Body SOI Single-Transistor Latch: Series-STL Equivalence, Continuous Tuning, and a Body Hole-Balance Model

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***Abstract*—A divided-body silicon-on-insulator (SOI) single-transistor latch (STL), in which a resistively grounded n^+ island splits the floating body into two series STLs inside one device, is studied with two-dimensional drift-diffusion TCAD. With hole transport across the island suppressed, the device latches twice, but it then reproduces two separately simulated STLs wired in series within 25 mV. Without lifetime killing, holes cross the island and couple the bodies: the second latch drops from 4.78 to 1.97 V, and the left STL departs from the series-circuit characteristic by up to 1.29 V with negative differential resistance. The island lifetime or width (15–200 nm) tunes the coupling continuously: with the first latch fixed at 1.44–1.45 V, the second latch moves between 1.97 and 4.78 V and the second-stage hysteresis between 0 and 2.27 V. A two-body hole-balance model explains the coupling. The holes are back-injected by the right STL into the island, in proportion to its body hole density and up to the plasma limit $\mu_p/(\mu_n + \mu_p)$, and cross the island by diffusion and drift over a decay length of 21 nm, derived from the island lifetime, the hole diffusivity and the loss into the via under the island. The model predicts the second-latch turn-off of every coupled island within 0.08 V and the turn-on of 30–90 nm islands within 0.2 V. A third jump, a regenerative n-p-n-p-n hole loop, was predicted for islands up to 40 nm only and confirmed by TCAD.**

***Index Terms*—Single-transistor latch (STL), silicon-on-insulator (SOI), floating body, impact ionization, parasitic bipolar transistor, multi-state latch, hole coupling, compact model, carrier lifetime, TCAD.**

I. Introduction

In a floating-body SOI MOSFET, holes generated by impact ionization (II) at the drain junction charge the body, forward-bias the body–source junction and turn on the parasitic lateral n-p-n bipolar transistor, whose electron injection increases II again. When this loop gain exceeds unity the drain current jumps by several decades and returns at a lower voltage: the single-transistor latch (STL) [1]. STLs have been used as bistable resistors (biristors) [2], capacitor-less 1T-DRAM [3], [4], leaky integrate-and-fire neurons [5]–[7] and oscillators [8], and low-voltage operation has been pursued [9]. These applications use two states. Ternary logic and multi-level elements need a third state; CMOS-compatible approaches include tunneling-based T-CMOS [12], a threshold switch in series with a MOSFET [10], [11], [13], feedback FETs [14] and gate–body diode MOSFETs [15]. A biristor threshold switch in series with a MOSFET [10], [11] keeps leakage low but needs two devices. Recently a bulk MOSFET with two latches, the triristor, was demonstrated [17]; its two latches share one p-well and are separated only by two current paths, so they can merge with bias.

A natural SOI alternative is to split the floating body physically. An n^+ island across the film divides the body into a left (source–island) and a right (island–drain) STL, and grounding the island through R_{tap} lets the right STL latch first and then raise the island potential until the left STL latches. This paper first shows how such a device reaches two separate latches and why the simpler structures latch only once. It then asks the question a reviewer of any such device should ask: is a fully decoupled divided-body device anything more than two STLs in series? We show that it is not—it reproduces a series STL pair—and that what a single device adds is the *hole coupling* between the two bodies across the island. That coupling makes the device depart from any series circuit, and its strength can be set continuously by the island lifetime or width.

The contributions are: (1) a step-by-step account of why body-doping splits, thickness splits, split gates, floating and tapped islands give one latch, and a hole-balance explanation of the two latches of the decoupled device (Sections III–IV); (2) a direct comparison with two separately simulated STLs in series, and three signatures of the coupled device that a series circuit cannot produce (Section V); (3) continuous tuning of the second latch and of the second-stage hysteresis by two knobs that collapse onto L_p/W_{IS}, with a gate-length control and the coupling limit (Section VI); (4) a two-body hole-balance model in the equivalent-circuit form of [16], in which the coupling is derived (back-injection by the right STL and drift–diffusion across the island with a 21 nm decay length), that predicts the second-latch turn-off and turn-on and the onset of a third, regenerative jump (Section VII).

II. Device and Simulation Method

The reference device (Fig. 1) has $L_g = 300$ nm, $T_{si} = 50$ nm, $t_{ox} = 20$ nm, $T_{box} = 200$ nm, n^+ S/D of 10^{20} cm^{-3}, a 30 nm n^+ island (10^{20} cm^{-3}) at mid-channel, left and right p-bodies of 6×10^{17} and 7×10^{17} cm^{-3}, $V_G = -0.2$ V,

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Simulation decks, analysis code and key logs are available at https://github.com/ashleysys04-blip/EE761_DividedBody.

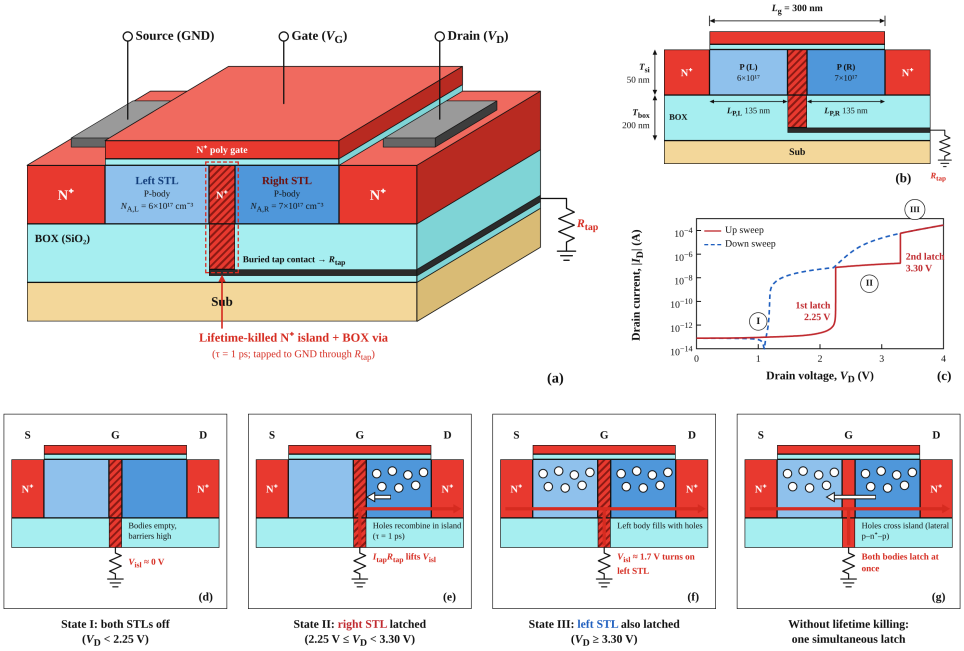


Fig. 1. Proposed divided-body SOI STL. (a) Left and right STLs share one gate; an n^+ island with a BOX via is grounded through R_{tap}. (b) Cross section of the reference device. (c) Two latches of the decoupled reference device (island lifetime 1 ps). (d)–(f) Body holes in states I–III. (g) Without lifetime killing, holes cross the island (lateral p-n^+-p) and both bodies latch at once.

$R_{tap} = 10$ MΩ and a width of 0.5 μm. The island is connected through an n^+ via in the BOX to a bottom tap electrode. Fig. 2 gives the equivalent circuit: each STL is a MOSFET with a parasitic n-p-n transistor on its floating body, charged by an II current source; the island node is the source of the right STL and the drain of the left STL.

Silvaco ATLAS [21] is used with `bgn`, `consrh`, `conmob`, `fldmob`, Fermi statistics, trap-assisted and band-to-band tunneling and the Selberherr II model [19], [20]. With `consrh` the effective SRH lifetime is $\tau_{eff} = \tau_0/(1 + N/N_{SRH})$, $N_{SRH} = 5 \times 10^{16}$ cm^{-3}; lifetimes quoted below are the base value τ_0, so $\tau_{eff} = \tau_0/2001$ in the island and $\approx \tau_0/14$ in the bodies. Because latching produces an S-shaped I–V on which a static voltage sweep stops at the fold, the drain is ramped in time, 0→6→0 V at 0.7 V/ms; the transient crosses the unstable branch and returns the jumps and hysteresis directly. A 100-fold change of the ramp rate moves the latches by ≤ 0.2 V. The final runs use MixedMode (device plus R_{tap} and sources), which agreed with device-only runs to four digits and was 20 times faster. A latch is defined as a change of the path current by more than one decade at a fixed applied voltage (within 2 mV) that reaches a real current level; numerical artifacts are excluded by checking the time step, the KCL residual, internal potentials and the gate displacement current.

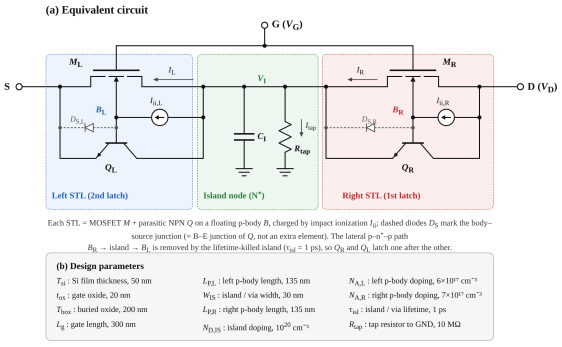


Fig. 2. (a) Equivalent circuit of the divided-body STL. In the decoupled device the island removes the lateral hole path; in the coupled device (Sections V–VI) an additional body-to-body hole current source is needed. (b) Design parameters of the reference device.

III. Why the Device Latched Only Once

Body-doping split. Small (4–12%) and large (2.3–10 times) left/right doping differences in a single body always gave one latch; the hole quasi-Fermi level stayed continuous across the doping step, because a p/p^+ step does not block majority holes, so the two regions cannot float to different potentials. An oxide notch under the body with a thin Si bridge, a left/right T_{si} split, a split gate and an n^+/n^-/p/n^+ stack also gave one latch. *Floating island.* A 30 nm n^+ island separated the two body potentials before latching (−0.02 and 0.36 V), but both bodies and the island jumped together at 3.26 V: with a floating island the right-STL current must flow through the left STL (series constraint). *Tapped island.* Grounding the island through R_{tap} removed this constraint, but at R_{tap} = 600, 60 and 10 kΩ the latch stayed at 2.990 V; zooming into the jump, the right body rose first and the left body followed within ≈ 10 ns. Holes injected from the right body into the 30 nm island crossed it and charged the left body: the right p-body, the island and the left p-body form a lateral p-n^+-p transistor. A 100 nm island still coupled the bodies, and a top ohmic contact on the island

let holes pass underneath it. Only reducing the lifetime of the island and via to 1 ps left the left STL off while the right STL latched alone. Raising R_{tap} to 10 MΩ then lifted the island potential enough to drive the left STL, and a standalone left STL showed that a body doping of 6×10^{17} cm^{-3} is needed for an abrupt latch (3 and 5×10^{17} turned on gradually).

IV. Decoupled Device: Two Latches and Their Mechanism

With the island killed (1 ps), the reference device latches at 2.251 V (right STL; I_{tap} jumps from 10^{-12} to 7×10^{-8} A, state I→II) and at 3.300 V (left STL; II→III), when the island potential reaches 1.67 V, close to the latch voltage of the standalone left STL in the same model (1.78 V). On the way down the left and right STLs turn off at ≈ 2.24 and ≈ 1.20 V, so both latches have hysteresis [Fig. 1(c)].

Twenty-eight solution snapshots were analyzed per STL: source–body electron barrier, II hole current $I_{ii} = qW\int G_{ii}dA$ and recombination in the body and in the n$^+$ region that acts as its source. For the first latch the right drain-junction field is 1.16×10^6 V/cm ($M - 1 \approx 0.25$); between 2.24 and 2.26 V, I_{ii} jumps by four decades and the right barrier collapses from 0.60 to 0.28 eV. After latching, I_{ii} equals body plus island recombination (e.g., $1.96 \times 10^{-8} \approx 1.06 \times 10^{-8} + 1.00 \times 10^{-8}$ A at 3.0 V). For the second latch the field at the left side of the island rises from 3.6×10^5 to 7.1×10^5 V/cm as the island potential rises, and between 3.28 and 3.32 V the left barrier collapses from 0.61 to 0.10 eV. The G_{ii} map shows generation only at the two drain-side junctions; holes from the right body recombine in the island, so the left STL is turned on only by its own drain field. The turn-off is set by the hole margin: at $\tau_{0,Si} = 10^{-7}$ s only 29% of the generated holes recombine at the last on-point, so the latch survives to low current, whereas at $\tau_{0,Si} = 10^{-8}$ s 78% are lost and the left STL falls by six decades within 20 mV at a holding current of 5.5×10^{-7} A.

Eighty-six single-parameter splits show that the two latches are designed independently: the right-body doping moves the first latch (1.24–2.51 V), the left-body doping the second (2.28–4.01 V), V_G moves both, R_{tap} divides the jump heights between them, and a shorter Si lifetime makes the turn-off abrupt at the cost of higher latch voltages. With $\tau_{0,Si} = 10^{-8}$ s and the island moved to 60% of L_g (left body 165 nm, right body 105 nm), the two hysteresis loops lie at 1.23–1.45 V and 2.56–4.78 V and are separated by 1.12 V. This device (island 30 nm, island lifetime 1 ps) is the decoupled reference for the rest of the paper.

V. Decoupled Device Equals a Series STL Pair

To test whether the decoupled device adds anything to a circuit, the island of the decoupled reference was replaced by a metal core through the Si film with a 10 nm n$^+$ shell (an implementable form of island recombination; first and second latch 1.499/4.616 V), and this device was then cut through the middle of the core into two independent ATLAS devices, each keeping its geometry, mesh and half of the core as its internal electrode. The two STLs were wired in series in MixedMode with the same R_{tap} and gate (CUT). A realistic pair of discrete SOI MOSFETs with 500 nm n$^+$ S/D and top contacts (SD) was also simulated. CUT reproduces the one-device result within 3 mV at the second latch and 25 mV elsewhere (Table I, Fig. 3(a)); SD differs by 0.19 V only through its geometry. A divided-body device with no hole transport across the island is therefore exactly a series STL pair: the separate latches alone are not a new function, only a more compact layout.

TABLE I
Series-Circuit Control (V; Turn-Off at $|I_S| < 10^{-8}$ A)

	1st on	2nd on	2nd off
one device, metal core	1.499	4.616	2.081
two STLs in series (CUT)	1.476	**4.613**	2.061
two STLs in series (SD)	1.471	4.428	2.019
one device, coupled island	1.444	**1.969**	1.747

Keeping the island lifetime at the Si value ($\tau_{0,isl} = 10^{-8}$ s, "coupled") changes this. The second latch drops by 2.6 V to 1.969 V, and the device departs from the series circuit in three ways. First, in a series circuit each STL current is set by its own terminal voltages, so the left-STL operating point ($|I_S|$, V_{tap}) must lie on the I–V of a standalone left STL with the same body (Fig. 3(b), gray). The killed-island device follows that curve within 0.03 V at 1–3 mA (2.269 vs 2.272 V at 1 mA). The coupled device carries the same current at a much lower voltage (1.724 V at 1 mA; 1.519 vs 2.469 V at 3 mA). Second, above 1 mA its left-STL voltage decreases as the current increases, a negative differential resistance that a monotonic standalone on-branch cannot produce. Third, a jump appears at 3.38 V. A hole balance of each body from the snapshots (generation, recombination and $\int J_p\,dy$ at the island edges) shows that the fraction of the left-body hole supply that has crossed the island rises from 23% at 3.0 V to 59% at 3.5 V: the jump closes an n-p-n-p-n hole loop from the right body through the island into the left body. With the island killed this fraction is zero and the jump is absent. Its condition is derived in Section VII. In circuit terms (Fig. 2), the coupled device needs a body-to-body hole current source in addition to the R_{tap} node; its magnitude is the coupling strength.

VI. Coupling Strength as a Design Knob

Holes entering the n$^+$ island diffuse as minority carriers over $L_p = \sqrt{D_p\tau_{eff}}$; with $\tau_{eff} = \tau_{0,isl}/2001$ and $D_p \approx 2$ cm^2/s, $L_p \approx 32$ nm $\times \sqrt{\tau_{0,isl}/10^{-8}\text{ s}}$ (Section VII derives 21 nm, with the simulator hole diffusivity and the loss into the via under the island; this rescales the L_p/W_{IS} axis uniformly). The coupling should therefore scale with L_p/W_{IS}, and it was varied in two ways from the reference: (i) the island lifetime $\tau_{0,isl} = 10^{-12}$–10^{-8} s at $W_{IS} = 30$ nm (only the two lifetime lines of the deck differ), and (ii) the island width $W_{IS} =$ 15–200 nm at $\tau_{0,isl} = \tau_{0,Si} = 10^{-8}$ s. The width sweep keeps both body lengths and widens only the island, so $L_g = 270$ nm$+W_{IS}$ grows with it; a killed island at $W_{IS} = 120$ nm separates this gate-length effect.

The results are listed in Table II and Fig. 4. The first latch (right STL) stays at 1.444–1.449 V in every case; only the

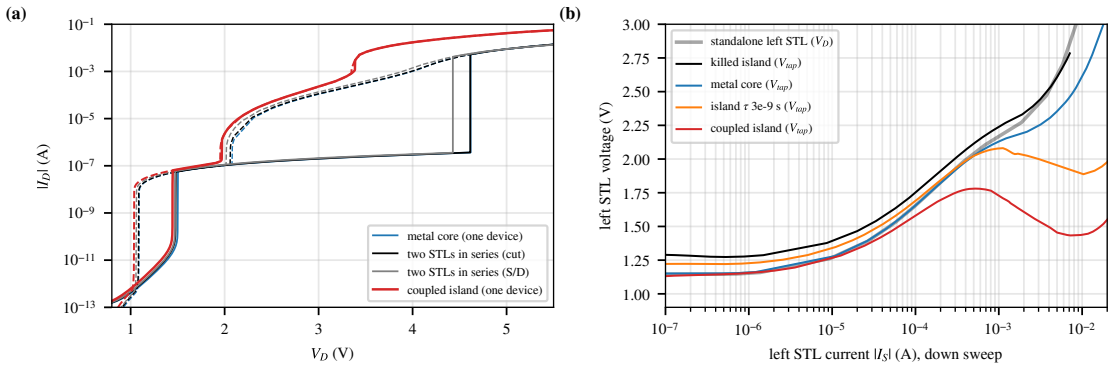


Fig. 3. Series-circuit control. (a) $|I_D|$–V_D (solid: up, dashed: down) of the metal-core device, two separately simulated STLs in series (CUT, SD) and the coupled device; CUT overlaps the metal-core device. (b) Left-STL operating point (V_{tap} vs $|I_S|$, down sweep) against a standalone left STL (V_D vs $|I_D|$, gray). A series circuit must lie on the gray curve.

TABLE II
SECOND LATCH VERSUS COUPLING STRENGTH. ON/OFF: ONE-DECADE JUMP AT FIXED APPLIED VOLTAGE (V); JUMP: DECADES OF $|I_D|$ AT TURN-ON

	L_p/W_{IS}	2nd on	2nd off	hyst.	jump
W_{IS} = 15 nm	2.13	cont.[a]	same curve	0	none
30 nm ($\tau_{0,isl} = 10^{-8}$ s)	1.07	1.969	1.956	0.01	0.8
45 nm	0.71	2.064	1.997	0.07	1.3
60 nm	0.53	2.193	2.019	0.17	1.8
90 nm	0.36	2.579	2.037	0.54	2.5
120 nm	0.27	3.339	2.040	1.30	3.2
200 nm	0.16	4.314	2.041	2.27	4.1
$\tau_{0,isl} = 3 \times 10^{-9}$ s (30 nm)	0.58	2.277	2.179	0.10	1.4
10^{-9} s	0.34	2.985	–[b]	–	–
10^{-10} s	0.11	4.742	2.526	2.22	3.7
10^{-11} s	0.03	4.776	2.562	2.21	3.7
killed (10^{-12} s), 30 nm	0.01	4.779	2.565	2.21	3.7
killed, 120 nm	0.003	4.761	2.577	2.18	3.6

[a] Continuous turn-on between 1.86 and 2.0 V. [b] Run stopped at 5.45 V (time limit).

second latch moves. In the lifetime sweep it stays at 4.74–4.78 V (series circuit) up to $\tau_{0,isl} = 10^{-10}$ s and falls to 2.99 V at 10^{-9} s and 1.97 V at 10^{-8} s. In the width sweep it falls from 4.31 V (200 nm) through 3.34, 2.58, 2.19 and 2.06 to 1.97 V (30 nm). The two sweeps fall on one curve versus L_p/W_{IS} [Fig. 4(b)]; at equal L_p/W_{IS} they differ by at most ≈ 0.3 V, which we attribute to the one-dimensional diffusion picture behind L_p/W_{IS}. Killing the 120 nm island gives 4.761/2.577 V, the same as the killed 30 nm island (4.779/2.565 V), although L_g grows from 0.30 to 0.39 μm; the width dependence of the coupled devices is therefore entirely due to coupling. The island width, a mask dimension, is the practical knob, whereas the lifetime knob needs a local, extreme lifetime control.

Hysteresis. The second turn-off stays at 2.00–2.04 V for all coupled widths from 45 to 200 nm, so the width moves only the turn-on and the second-stage hysteresis is tuned continuously from 2.27 V to zero [Fig. 4(c)]. The low turn-off is itself a coupling effect (2.04 V coupled vs 2.58 V killed at 120 nm): at 3.0 V on the down sweep the coupled island holds 10^{16}–10^{17} cm^{-3} holes and keeps feeding the left body, whereas the killed island stays below 10^4 cm^{-3} (Section VII).

Limit of strong coupling. The height of the second jump falls from 4.1 decades (200 nm) to 0.8 decades (30 nm), and at 15 nm the left STL turns on without a jump between 1.86 and 2.0 V and returns along the same curve: the two bodies behave as one hole reservoir. We take 30–120 nm as the tuning range and 200 nm, where the island is wider than either body, as the limit toward zero coupling.

Deviation from the series circuit. With the operating-point test of Fig. 3(b) applied to every run [Fig. 4(d)], the left-STL voltage at 3 mA lies -1.29 to -0.11 V from the standalone characteristic for W_{IS} = 15 to 200 nm and returns to -0.03/$+0.07$ V when the 30/120 nm islands are killed; the lifetime sweep lies on the same curve. The departure from a series STL pair thus holds over the whole tuning range, and its size is set by the coupling strength.

VII. TWO-BODY HOLE-BALANCE MODEL

Following the equivalent-circuit approach of [16], each floating body is a node whose hole charge is set by the balance of hole generation and hole loss. The divided-body device needs one more element: a hole current source that links the two bodies through the island.

A. Model Equations

With I the left-STL electron current $|I_S|$ and V the island potential, the left body in steady state obeys

$$\big(M_L(V) - 1\big)I + \eta\, I_D + G_0 = \frac{I}{\beta_L(I)}, \qquad I_D = I + \frac{V}{R_{tap}}, \tag{1}$$

where the left side collects impact-ionization holes, holes arriving from the island and other generation ($G_0 = 10^{-15}$ A), and the right side is the hole loss by recombination and back-injection into the source. In states II and III the right STL is latched, $M_R - 1 = 1/\beta_R(I_D)$, which gives its on-branch $V_R(I_D)$, and $V_D = V + V_R(I_D)$. For every I, (1) has one solution V because its left side rises with V; the resulting $V_D(I)$ is S-shaped. The up sweep jumps at its local maxima, where the loop gain of [16] reaches unity, and the down sweep drops at its local minima.

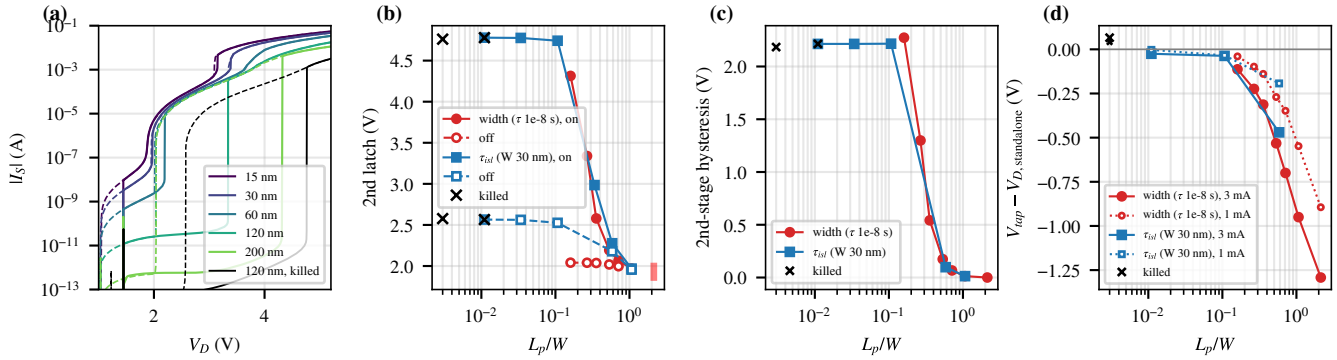


Fig. 4. Continuous tuning of the coupling. (a) Left-STL current of the width sweep (solid: up, dashed: down; black: 120 nm, island killed). (b) Second-latch turn-on (filled) and turn-off (open) versus L_p/W_{IS}: red, width sweep; blue, island-lifetime sweep; ×, killed islands (30, 120 nm); the bar marks the continuous turn-on at 15 nm. (c) Second-stage hysteresis (0 at 15 nm). (d) Deviation of the left-STL operating point from the series circuit (standalone left STL) at $|I_S|$ = 3 mA (solid) and 1 mA (dotted), down sweep.

The coupling is the product of the holes the right STL injects into the island and the fraction that crosses it:

$$\eta = \gamma_R(I_D)\, T(W_{IS}, \tau_{0,isl}, I_D). \tag{2}$$

Injection. The island is the emitter of the right STL. The junction law $p_{isl}(0)\, n_{isl} = p_R\, n_R$ makes the back-injected hole current per drain electron proportional to the hole density p_R of the right body. Extracted from the snapshots, $\gamma_R = 0.019\, p_R/N_{A,R}$ holds for all widths up to ≈1 mA [Fig. 5(b)]; p_R rises with current as the body is charged by its own impact ionization and then enters high injection. Above ≈10 mA the bodies and the island form a plasma ($n \approx p \approx 10^{19}$–$10^{20}$ cm^{-3}) in which holes drift with the electrons, and γ_R saturates at $\gamma_\infty = \mu_p/(\mu_n + \mu_p)$. We write

$$\gamma_R = \frac{g_R\, q_b}{1 + g_R\, q_b/\gamma_\infty}, \qquad q_b = \tfrac{1}{2}\big(1 + \sqrt{1 + 4I_D/I_{KF,R}}\big), \tag{3}$$

with the Gummel–Poon high-injection factor q_b.

Transmission. Holes injected at the right island edge are collected at the left edge of an n$^+$ base of width W_{IS}. In the island they diffuse and drift in the ohmic field $E = J_D/(qN_D\mu_n)$ of the drain current: $L^2 p'' - L_E p' - p = 0$ with $L_E = \mu_p E \tau_p$, whose solution gives T in closed form; $T \to 1/\cosh(W_{IS}/L)$ at low current. The decay length follows from the island parameters alone. The bulk value $L_p = \sqrt{D_p \tau_p}$, with $\tau_p = \tau_{0,isl}/(1+N_D/N_{SRH}) = 5\times10^{-12}$ s and the hole diffusivity of the simulator in the 10^{20} cm^{-3} island ($D_p = 1.35$ cm^2/s), is 26.0 nm. Holes moving along the 50 nm film are also lost into the n$^+$ via under the island, a second sink deeper than L_p, so that $1/\tau_{eff} = (1 + L_p/t_{si})/\tau_p$ and

$$L = \frac{L_p}{\sqrt{1 + L_p/t_{si}}} = 21.0 \text{ nm}. \tag{4}$$

Single-STL quantities. $M - 1$ and $1/\beta$ are extracted from the hole balance of the left body, as from a Gummel plot. For all runs, $M - 1$ is one function of V and $1/\beta$ one function of I; $1/\beta$ falls from 0.8 at 10^{-11} A to 0.05 near 1 μA and rises to 0.35 at 10 mA. The left STL's own impact-ionization holes generated on the island side of its drain junction (η_{self}, the η of the killed island) are added to the generation. The island lifetime also changes the right STL, whose emitter it is: a killed island is a strong sink for its back-injection and needs 0.45 V more right-STL voltage at the same current, whereas coupled islands of any width give the same on-branch. Two reference curves $V_R(I_D)$ are therefore used, from the killed and the coupled 30 nm devices. Table III lists the parameters; apart from these references and the 30 nm injection fit, every run is a prediction.

TABLE III
PARAMETERS OF THE TWO-BODY HOLE-BALANCE MODEL

Quantity	Value / expression	Source
τ_p (island)	$\tau_{0,isl}/(1 + N_D/N_{SRH})$	consrh
D_p, μ_n (island)	1.35 cm^2/s, 90 cm^2/Vs	simulator
L	$L_p/\sqrt{1 + L_p/t_{si}}$ = 21.0 nm	(4)
γ_∞	$\mu_p/(\mu_n + \mu_p)$ = 0.37	plasma limit
T	drift–diffusion, $E = J_D/(qN_D\mu_n)$	derived
g_R, $I_{KF,R}$	0.020, 7.4 μA	30 nm injection
$M_L - 1$	$0.86/[1 + e^{-(V-2.70)/0.52}]$	extracted, all runs
$1/\beta_L$	$0.032\, i^{-0.28} + 0.016\, i^{0.50}/(1 + (I/0.48\,\text{mA})^{0.50})$, $i = I/1\ \mu$A	extracted, all runs
η_{self}, $V_R(I_D)$	killed / coupled 30 nm devices	references

B. Comparison with TCAD

With the left STL off, the derived $\gamma_R T$ follows the extracted coupling over five decades from 15 to 200 nm and predicts the $\tau_{0,isl} = 3 \times 10^{-9}$ s point [Fig. 5(a)]: the exponential width dependence and the $\sqrt{\tau}$ scaling of the two knobs come from one diffusion length, (4), which agrees with the 21.3 nm extracted from the coupling. Above 1 mA the drift term makes the island transparent ($T \to 1$ for 15 nm), as in TCAD within 5–20% [Fig. 5(c)]. Fig. 5(d)–(f) compares the predicted I–V. The second-latch turn-off is reproduced within 0.08 V for every coupled island (1.91–2.05 vs 1.96–2.04 V) and for the killed islands (2.58 vs 2.56–2.58 V): the 0.5 V lower turn-off of a coupled island is the island hole current that keeps the left body charged. On the on-branch, (1) reads

$M-1=1/\beta-\eta I_D/I$, so

$$\frac{d\ln I}{dV}=\frac{d\ln(M-1)/dV}{d\ln(1/\beta-\eta I_D/I)/d\ln I}: \tag{5}$$

the slanted down sweep is the field sensitivity of impact ionization divided by the current roll-off of β. The turn-on is predicted within 0.09–0.18 V for 30–90 nm and exactly for $\tau_{0,isl}=3\times10^{-9}$ s (2.28 V); the 120 and 200 nm islands deviate by -0.37 and $+0.28$ V. The model does not reproduce the turn-on of killed islands, which occurs at island potentials above the extracted range of $M-1$ (2.8 V), nor the continuous turn-on at 15 nm, where it keeps a 1.5-decade jump.

C. Third Jump: A Regenerative Hole Loop

On the on-branch, the island holes replace part of the left body's own generation. When $\beta_L\eta\to1$ they replace almost all of it; $V(I)$ then decreases with current, and where this negative slope is steeper than the series resistance of the right STL, $V_D(I)$ folds a third time. The condition is that of a thyristor ($\alpha_{npn}+\alpha_{pnp}=1$) applied to the n-p-n-p-n loop right body–island–left body. At 50 mA, $\beta_L\eta$ extracted from the snapshots is 0.94, 0.88, 0.76 and 0.5 for 15, 30, 60 and 120 nm. Fitting the extracted $\eta(I_D,W_{IS})$ at each current over 15–120 nm gives $\eta=\eta_0(I_D)\exp[-W_{IS}/L_{eff}(I_D)]$ with L_{eff} growing from 19 to 170 nm and $\eta_0\beta_L\to1.0$ above 10 mA; with this form the balance predicts the third fold for $W_{IS}\le40$ nm and none from 42.5 nm. Two additional TCAD runs confirmed the prediction: the jump within 1 mV is 0.61, 0.41, 0.29 and 0.21 decade at 15, 30, 35 and 40 nm and zero at 45, 60 and 90 nm [Fig. 5(f), green]. Across the jump the island hole density rises from 2–3 $\times10^{17}$ to 3.5–4.9×10^{19} cm^{-3}, the plasma regime of (3). The present model, with $M-1$ independent of current, does not yet fold; the jump is an isothermal result at $\approx$6 mA/μm, and we do not claim it as a fourth state.

VIII. Discussion

Implementation. The two ends of the coupling range have different physical forms. Zero coupling needs an island effective lifetime of $\le5\times10^{-14}$ s or a metal core through the film (Section V; modeled as an ideal ohmic boundary); intermediate coupling needs only the island width at the Si lifetime. The body lifetime of $\tau_{0,Si}=10^{-8}$ s used for abrupt turn-off is within conventional lifetime control (Au/Pt diffusion, electron or proton irradiation) [18], and R_{tap} = 1–10 MΩ can be a high-resistance poly-Si resistor.

Use of the coupling knob. With the first latch fixed, the coupling sets where the second latch fires and how wide its hysteresis is. A wide second-stage window suits a three-state memory or a ternary threshold element; a narrow one gives a second, nearly reversible switching step. The decoupled device behaves as a series pair, so circuit models of series STLs, including current-driven relaxation oscillation, apply directly; for the coupled device the island node needs the additional hole current source ηI_D of (1)–(4), and the island lifetime also changes the right STL through its emitter loss.

Limitations. All results are 2D, isothermal drift-diffusion. Local-field II overestimates generation in short channels: in the standalone left STL the energy-balance (hydrodynamic) latch was 0.7–0.8 V higher than the DD one. Full-device energy-balance runs of the decoupled device stopped at 3.6–5.3 V because the electron temperature at the right drain junction exceeded 10^4 K and the time step collapsed, despite coupled Newton, a 1 nm mesh, relaxed tolerances, MixedMode and graded drains. An energy-balance run of the 30 nm coupled device, whose second latch lies lower, shows weaker II (no first latch below 3 V) and had not converged beyond 3.06 V; the second latch is therefore a DD result. An attempt to calibrate the II coefficients to a measured double-latch bulk device [17] matched its Id–Vg but not its first latch, and a 20% change of the Selberherr B coefficient moved a coefficient-sensitive latch by $\approx$20%. Absolute voltages are thus uncertain by roughly $\pm$20%, whereas the comparisons in this paper (coupled vs killed vs series circuit at the same model) do not depend on the coefficients. Self-heating at the mA/μm currents of state III is not included; lattice-heating runs of the coupled device did not start in the present MixedMode setup.

IX. Conclusion

A divided-body SOI STL with a resistively grounded n$^+$ island latches twice once hole transport across the island is removed, and each latch is the point where II hole generation in one body overcomes recombination. Such a decoupled device is, however, a series STL pair: two separately simulated STLs in series reproduce it within 25 mV. What a single device adds is the hole coupling between the bodies. The coupled device departs from the series characteristic by up to 1.29 V at 3 mA and shows negative differential resistance, and its coupling is tuned continuously by the island lifetime or, more practically, the island width. With the first latch fixed at 1.44–1.45 V, the second latch spans 1.97–4.78 V and the second-stage hysteresis 0–2.27 V, without a gate-length effect; the strongest coupling (15 nm) removes the second latch. A two-body hole-balance model shows where the coupling comes from: holes back-injected by the right STL into the island, in proportion to its body hole density and up to the plasma limit, that cross the island by diffusion over 21 nm, a length set by the island lifetime, the hole diffusivity and the via under the island, and by drift at high current. The model predicts the second-latch turn-off of all coupled islands within 0.08 V, the turn-on of 30–90 nm islands within 0.2 V and the slanted down sweep, and its regenerative-loop condition predicted that a third jump exists only for islands up to 40 nm, as TCAD confirmed. Remaining work is the current dependence of the multiplication and the off-state body bias, which set the turn-on of weakly coupled islands and the third fold, energy-balance and self-heating checks, and calibration against measured SOI devices.

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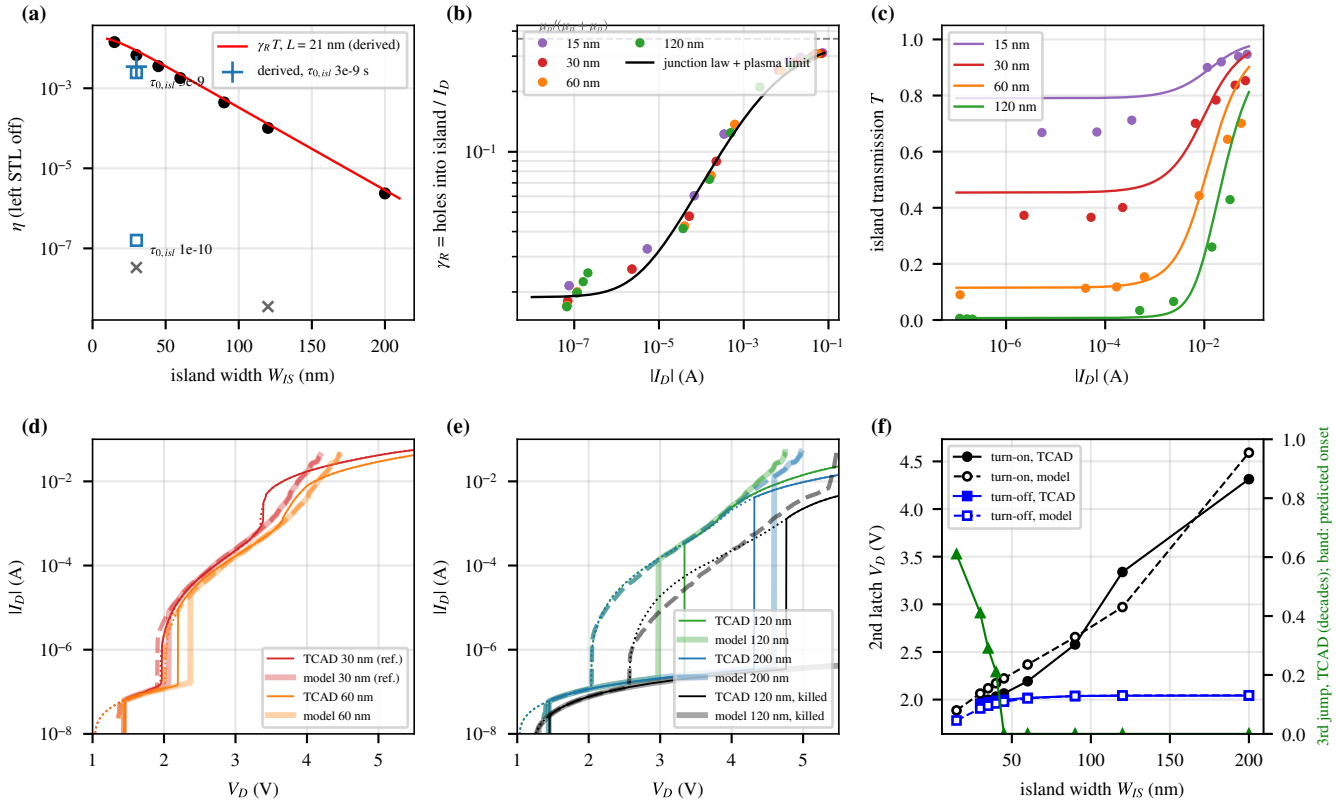


Fig. 5. Two-body hole-balance model. (a) Island coupling with the left STL off versus island width (circles), island lifetime (squares) and killed islands (×), with the derived $\gamma_R T$ (2)–(4) and its prediction for $\tau_{0,isl} = 3 \times 10^{-9}$ s (cross). (b) Holes back-injected by the right STL into the island per drain electron (symbols: 15–120 nm) and (3). (c) Island hole transmission, TCAD (symbols) and drift–diffusion (lines). (d), (e) $|I_D|$–V_D, TCAD (thin; solid up, dotted down) and model (thick; solid up, dashed down). (f) Second-latch turn-on and turn-off versus width, TCAD (filled) and model (open), and the third jump in TCAD (green, right axis) with the predicted onset (band).

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